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Quick Tips For "Fast Results Marketing"

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R-r-r-i-n-g. DON'T answer that phone.

In many cases, the use of the "free recorded message" (as in this simple ad) actually increases response vs. a regular phone number. This is called "non-threatening response"; the person knows they are NOT going to confront and deal with a "live" human being who will try to convince them to do something, embarrass them or otherwise make them feel uncomfortable. Another option: offer the alternative call to action - for egs., the ad's CTA could be re-written:

FOR IMMEDIATE ASSISTANCE, CALL 000-0000 OR FOR YOUR FREE REPORT, Call the Foot Help Line: FREE RECORDED MESSAGE, 24 hrs. a day, 7 days a week: 000-0000.

WHY USING LEAD GENERATION ADVERTISING ALMOST ALWAYS BEATS MAILING "COLD" TO RENTED LISTS

According to 'Operations & Fulfillment Magazine' (11/95) one of the top ten tough issues facing the catalog industry is: continuing complaints about unasked for mail. Most consumers don't want to deal with more pieces of paper. Their attitude is - if I haven't asked for it, I don't want it. EXACTLY! That's why the usual winner in strategy is to get people to ask for your information, then provide it. Be an "Invited Guest", NOT an "Unwelcome Pest."

IC Member Tim Dempset wanted to know how to do better with his continuously running ad in a drilling industry suppliers directory. This is a perfect opportunity to use direct lead generation, so I suggested keeping everything in his ad the same but adding this at its bottom:

And/or for a FREE 4-Page Pipe Buyer's Guide (featuring "6 Mistakes We Hope You NEVER Make Buying Pipe"), a 1-page list of current inventory specials, and a coupon good for your choice of FREE TOOLS as a bonus gift for first-time customers, call for details on our FREE RECORDED MESSAGE: 1-800-333-PIPE or FAX your business card to: 000/000-0000.

This strategy may make his ad work harder....provide better measurement of its performance....stand out from the other advertisers....and provide quality leads for his sales reps to follow up on. (This example also demonstrates how this applies in industrial settings, too.)

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Several IC Members have asked about using Welcome Wagon to market to new move-ins.

DSK: Welcome Wagon has about 2,000 reps, each with ten local business sponsors each (average), paying $2 to $3 per home visit, to "welcome" about 750,000 new residents, and the company is on an aggressive growth push on two levels: adding more reps and local sponsors AND (for the first time) signing national sponsors on a category exclusivity basis - which may mean, for example, that a Pizza Hut or Dominos will come in, all local pizza joints will be bumped out. The Welcome Wagon rep personally delivers a gift basket with literature, a free gift and another free gift offer from each sponsor. Sponsors get names, addresses and phone numbers for follow-up. I happen to be a big believer in Welcome Wagon. I can show you chiropractors, dentists, restaurants and retailers who've benefited enormously. Many moons ago, my parents used Welcome Wagon as THE means of acquiring new, retail customers for their Amway business, and built one of the largest Amway retail businesses in northeastern Ohio as a result. Here are the keys: (a) a good relationship with the rep(s) doing the home visits; (b) a good package in the basket - including an irresistible, timed offer; (c) immediate follow-up by letter and/or phone; (d) sequential follow-up for those who do not immediately respond - in the service, the gifts, the discounts and follow-up, in total, investing $10 to $15 per prospect. Welcome Wagon was recently acquired by CUC, by the way - CUC is the largest provider of private labeled travel, dining and discount buying "clubs".

In addition to or in place of Welcome Wagon, you might check with your local MoneyMailer franchisee; MoneyMailer now has its own, targeted coupon pak mailing program just for new residents, by area, and Dan Olsen tells me some advertisers are getting response rates as high as 18%!

CARD DECK ADVERTISING: PROS, CONS, FACTS, FICTION, ACTUAL RESULTS

A "card deck" is that postcard-sized cellophane package you get in the mail with 100, 200, more individual cards in it, each from a different advertiser. 90% of all card decks are business-to-business, not consumer oriented. And the growth in recent years has been extraordinary - there are now over 1,000 card decks you can advertise in, each (at least, in theory) targeted to a specific prospect/customer, by type of business or industry, association affiliation, magazine subscription, or purchasing history. (*See examples, end of article.)

The biggest attraction to advertisers is low cost. About 3 to 4-cents per card gets your 2-sided ad delivered....compare to your own costs to print, handle, pay postage for and mail a postcard or flyer, let alone a sales letter. Many card decks will also charge you per inquiry/per sale instead of a flat rate, letting you pay for results, as you go, or secured by a deposit.

What Kind Of Results Can You Expect?

My overall experience is that this very attractive low cost is offset by very low "quality" of response. By that I mean, some people send back EVERY card offering anything for free regardless of level of interest (they usually use labels or attach business cards, by the way, rather than filling in the card); there is quite a bit of "junk" in these lists; and, unlike other methods of lead generation advertising, there's no linkage -- the prospect does not remember you, by having returned the card, so when your follow-up mailing

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reaches him it is more like unsolicited mail than something requested arriving. As a result, the percentage of response to the offers sent to these leads tends to be very low. It is common to be dealing with card deck-generated lead conversion rates of below 2%.

On a hierarchy of quality, a person who has responded to your ad by calling in "live" or to a recorded message, requested information, and can, within 72 hours, be sent that material, so that he knows and remembers he asked for it, and treats it as important, is a "10"....a name chosen from a compiled mailing list a "3"...a name from the White Pages at random a "1." Most card deck generated leads would be a "5" or better, but no better than a "7". (From a "10", by the way, I'd look for conversion rates of 10%+.)

Lead Generation & Multi-Step Vs. One-Step

Card decks are predominately used as lead generation media, rather than to one-step a sale - although there are advertisers who do make card decks pay off for one-step offers, notably including Ted Nicholas, for various business books. Personally, I've never even attempted using them for one-step; my uses have all been lead generation. More one-step marketing is being attempted, though, as card decks become more fexible in accomodating and accepting double-sized cards, full color printing, inserting of brochures, and adding 800# to mail-in response in per inquiry and per order situations.

Some of the card deck advertisers who consistently achieve satisfactory results:

1. *Big Ticket Item Sellers* - companies generating leads for the sale of very expensive business equipment, investments, franchises and professional services, all allowing for a high cost of sale. A company selling a $5,000.00 "item" with a $2,000.00 gross profit can obviously afford a much higher lead cost and higher total sale cost than an advertiser selling a $100 book with a $70 gross profit. These type of advertisers often include telemarketing in their follow-up sequence too.

2. *Cataloguers* - generating new names for catalog mailing lists. These companies are accustomed to going in the negative to acquire new customers.

3. *Companies Generating Leads For "Live" Salesforces.*

4. *Charities - where there is NO subsequent cost of product.*

The Process Of Making Card Deck Advertising Work For You

A great deal of testing and refining may be necessary to make a card deck driven marketing system pay off. I'll share my own example: during the last four months or so, we've begun experimenting with a "Free Book Offer" in card decks, to generate leads, to sell this newsletter subscription to. Here are all the "variables" that can be tested:

1. Decks - one deck vs. another for cost of lead and ultimate cost of sale
2. Card - the copy and the graphic appearance of the card
3. Offer - the item, the premiums
4. Follow-Up Letter/Package "A" - copy, graphics, etc.
5. Offer made in Follow-up Pkg. - item(s), premiums, price, terms
6. Subsequent Follow-Up Steps

As you can see, putting these all into a matrix gives you a whole lot of testing that might be required, to arrive at THE winning combination.

Here Are ACTUAL "Inside" Test Results

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In my case, out of the gate, we were at about a $6.00 per lead; $260.00 cost per sale -- against a $149.00 sale. The lead cost was slightly higher than I had expected, but the total cost per sale nearly double my goal. Improvements to the card brought the lead cost down to about $4.50 in the next test, but the cost per sale dropped only by that same small differential. For the next test, a major overhaul of the follow-up mailing package was done, in copy, appearance, and a new offer significantly strengthened with multiple premiums. This has brought the total cost per sale down to about $190.00. We are now revamping the entire follow-up mailing again, including going from black-plus-one-color printing to full-color printing of the 16-page sales letter/magalog, and I am re-writing the other enclosure; a paperback book; and considering options for lowering its cost. Hopefully, these changes will bring the cost of sale down from $190.00 to $140.00.

We have not yet tested a second follow-up mailing. The main reason for that is that, in most cases, the sequence of follow-up mailings needs to build added profits on top of at least a break-even first mailing; I don't want to (have to) use two or more mailings just to get to break-even.

For me to happily use a number of card decks on a continuing basis, in this case, I'll need to get my cost of sale down to $100 to $120. This will be a TRUE break-even, including cost of sale AND cost of fulfillment, against a $149 selling price, with a couple bucks left over.

Some companies in the newsletter business (and other businesses) might be well satisfied with acquiring new subscribers (customers) at a cost of $50.00 each, to be recovered later through renewals or other sales, and there's nothing necessarily wrong with such a strategy - although it obviously requires and risks considerable capital to grow a business with that premise. Doing so is beyond my capital resources and personal comfort zone. I insist that each method of acquiring customers pay for itself or, preferably, produce a direct profit. There is no doubt that this has stunted and retarded the growth of the size of my business over the years, and a big, cash-rich company could take my business and dramatically increase it with ease. These are choices you have to weigh and make for yourself.

Why Go To All This Trouble
To Make This Media Work?

Continuing to use my newsletter business as the example - why would I go to all this trouble to make this media work? There are a number of reasons. **One** is the simplicity: because of the constant turnover in card deck lists, once I have a card that produces a desireable cost per lead, I may be able to use that card for 3, 5, even 10 years without changing it one iota. And placement in decks is less complicated than dealing with other media. One card deck publisher may control a dozen or more decks I can use, rather than having to deal with twelve different magazine publishers. **Two** is control: the bulk of the expense, the bulk of the variables to be tested and re-tested are "behind" the deck, in my follow-up mailings. **Three**: cost. Card decks ARE inexpensive and require less investment than other media. **Four**: size of universe. One card deck publisher may be able to give me targeted distribution in the millions each month. **Five**: system. Once I get a card deck driven system working, it can run on auto-pilot virtually forever.

Legitimate Vs. Illegitimate Card Decks

No, all decks are not created equal. The quality of the list(s) the deck is mailed to, the source(s) of those names, and the recency of those names are all very important factors.

As a big, general rule: beware of decks with shockingly low rates and that are NOT represented by direct-response industry brokers. There is one author/publisher/marketing guru (his initials are J.L.) who puts out his own card deck, with space at about half price against going rate. Very attractive! Fool's gold. We tested his deck and got the worst results from ANY ad

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investment in ten years. His list *must* be junk. The conversion rate was near zero.

Insist on seeing several back issues of a given deck, to determine if the advertisers are repeating over and over, or not. And only value use by true direct response advertisers who track results and measure return-on-investment.

You can (and should) do your homework at a main city public library, with SRDS' directory of card decks in publication. New decks are described in every issue of DM NEWS.

You can also solicit suggestions from publishers of a number of different decks. The more information you can give about the person most likely to respond to your offer, the better the advice you may get.

The largest, very reputable card deck publisher in America is VENTURE COMMUNICATIONS, based in New York. You can contact Richard Baumer there at 212-684-4800 or FAX 212-576-1129. Be sure to ID yourself as a Kennedy Inner Circle Member when requesting a kit of information from Venture.

Here's a sampling of the different types of decks you can advertise in (all of these managed by Venture):

PURCHASERS
Clement Communications Action Pac- 100,000+ BUYERS of employee training and supervisory products and publications.

Prentice-Hall's Health & Natural Healing - 200,000+ BUYERS of books, newsletters, other products related to physical or mental health.

SUBSCRIBERS
NursePac - 150,000 subscribers to "Nursing 94" Magazine
Success - 300,000 subscribers to Success Magazine

COMPILED - BY BUSINESS/OCCUPATION
Wiley & Sons' Accounting & Finance - 115,000 accountants, CPA's, bank and financial executives

McGraw-Hill's Architecture - 60,000 registered architects, design engineers, and interior designers.

COMPILED - BY SPECIAL INTEREST
Investor's Advantage Opportunity Pac - 250,000 investment, business opportunity and franchise buyers

International Marine Card Pac - 75,000 boat owners

For consumer marketers, the national equivalent of card decks is package insert programs; the local equivalent, coupon cooperative mailings. We'll discuss these in the next Issue of THE NO BS MARKETING LETTER.

HOW TO INCREASE THE 3 R'S OF GOOD SALESMANSHIP...

Retention
Referrals and
Repeat Sales

Getting a new customer is a very small part of selling. One-shot sales, however, don't help you to build a predictable, secure and growing business. It takes more than glib talk, a big smile, shined shoes and a few glowing promises to build customer loyalty and repeat business.

The key to a consistent income in selling is the development of clientele. The salesperson who carefully develops positive relationships with his customers builds a strong foundation for his future. When enough customers

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are firmly established, you can expect repeat business and an assured income that provides a firm foundation for your livelihood That's what professionals call a "customer base."

The salesperson can go back to these customers with new products or services with the knowlege that they will get a favorable reception. It's also likely that the positive attitudes that have been established will make it easier to get referrals.

The building of relationships with customers is the key to keeping them, getting repeat business from them, and acquiring referrals. It can be the difference between worrying about your next meal and having a reliable income base.

Why don't salespople make it a priority to build strong relationships with their clients? One reason is simple laziness. It takes time and effort. Consequently, many salespeople ignore this part of their job.

Another reason is competition. This competition takes many forms. It's not only other salespeople selling similar products. It's an enormous amount of competition from innumerable sources for your customer's interest attention and dollars.

Reliable research indicates that today the average adult is bombarded with more invitations to spend money in one eight-hour period than he was in 30 twenty-four hour periods only five years ago. An example of this is the switch from 60-second TV commercials to 30-second commercials. This makes it possible to have twice as many commercials in the same time slot. More catalogs were mailed last fall than in any previous fall in U.S. history. There is tremendous competition for your customer's attention, interest and spendable dollars.

You cannot match all this competition blow for blow, dollar for dollar. The secret is to do things to stay on top of your customer's consciousness. Being remembered and well-thought of is half the battle!

You've probably heard this adage: out of sight, out of mind. If you're out of the customer's mind at the moment he needs something you sell or at the moment a competing salesperson contacts him, you'll lose out on repeat business from that customer.

Another old adage also applies. It is: what you take for granted, you lose. If your customer feels ignored or neglected and thinks your only interest is the dollars you earn from his orders, you're likely to lose him to someone else.

Your objective, then, is to mount a planned campaign to let the customer know that you care about him, value the relationship and are eager to be of service.

Here are a few ideas for your campaign:

1. Organize your customers on a mailing list. Send mailings to those on the list at least six times a year. This contact program might include a Christmas card, mailings about new products and services, news about special offers and thank you notes for orders you have gotten. You can use letters, flyers and postcards. The important thing is that the customer is periodically reminded that you are ready to be of service, and that you are eager to keep him posted on special opportunities.

2. In most businesses, you'll sell more and increase your value to the customer by teaching proper, most effective usage of what you sell. Some salespeople collect new product use ideas and tips from their customers, put them together in tip-sheets and occasionally mail these out to all their customers. This kind of information can even form the basis for a newsletter that can be sent to customers several times a year.

3. Advertising specialties such as pens, calendars, scratch pads and other items useful to your customers, imprinted with your name and identification information, frequently remind your customers to do business with you. Choose items appropriate for your customers and your business. Visual reminders are a good investment.

4. Develop special opportunities to contact clients. One salesman, for example, keeps a tickler file of his clients and their wedding anniversary dates. He calls each one a week ahead of time to remind them of their

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anniversary. Special strategies like this can create tremendous goodwill and loyalty.

The salesperson who survives on the basis of one sale at a time is constantly in search of the next new customer. He cheats himself with his shortsightedness. Because of his lack of planning, he is constantly under pressure and stress.

Choose, instead, to build a reliable customer base that will provide you with repeat business and referrals. Like other professionals, your success depends on the relationships you establish and the reputation you build for yourself. If you do your job properly, you can build a business that will be rewarding...one that will provide a secure financial future for you and your family.

THE SECRET OF GETTING REFERRALS

There has never been any argument in advertising circles that the most effective business advertising is word-of-mouth advertising.

That's why direct selling is so dramatically successful as a method of marketing every imaginable product and service, and why direct selling is such a great business in which to be. As a direct sales person conversationally telling another person why you like a particular product, you are a much more convincing advertisement than any TV commercial or magazine ad.

The tremendous persuasiveness of your personal endorsement of a product is what word-of-mouth advertising is all about. Much to the chagrin of professional ad agencies, such word-of-mouth advertising cannot be purchased. But you, as a direct salesperson, can put this special type of advertising power to work for your business.

Because you are fortunate to be on friendly, personal terms with your customers, you can enlist their aid in promoting your products. You can actually turn your present customers into a personal advertising department! All you need do is master the right way to ask for their help.

Develop Personal Relations

If you learn how to properly ask for their help, your customers will enthusiastically go to work advertising your business! They will help promote your products, lead you to scores of new customers, and give you all the valuable benefits of word-of-mouth advertising.

There are two types of word-of-mouth advertising:

2 The customer actually becomes an advertising agent and tells others about you and the product line you are handling.

2 The customer gives you referrals to people who may be good prospects and allows you to use ther name as an endorsement.

Either type of word-of-mouth advertising can be extremely valuable in multiplying your customer list. If each of your present customers, for example, can be turned into six, seven or eight customers, your sales are going to take a big jump. And you can continue the same multiplication process with each set of new customers!

Avoid Pressure

The most important thing to remember is that this kind of help cannot be bought from your customers. It must never seem like you're offering a bribe in exchange for a list of names. The offer of a product gift or cash in exchange for prospect names is a cold, impersonal barter which most people will reject. As a rule, people will not "sell" their friends to you. Offering an "inducement" also might raise doubts about the quality of your products. If

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they are as good as you say they are, why should you bribe people for their recommendations?

Remember two very important things about human nature: first, people usually enjoy telling others about products they try and like. Second, people like to be appreciated. One way they get appreciation is by being helpful to others.

Any offer that seems like an out-and-out exchange, a payment for assistance, goes against the desire to be helpful. On the other hand, few people are eager to "give something for nothing." So it is often necessary to give customers an incentive to help you in your search for new prospects.

In short, you'll be walking a tightrope. You will need to offer an incentive for help without appearing to be paying for it. Your customer must want to help you without feeling compelled to do so by a bargain that has been struck.

The secret to successfully walking that tightrope is in a simple four point formula:

1) Make sure your customer is satisfied and remind her of it.

Make certain your customer is happy with your products and you as a salesperson. Gently introduce a reminder of that satisfaction into the conversation before requesting the customer's assistance. You might, for example, say, "It's been over a year now that you've been buying XYZ Products from me, Mrs. Smith, and I'm very glad to have you as a satisfied customer."

2) Make your customer aware of your desire to expand your business.

Many customers never think to suggest any friends who might be interested in a salesperson's products. Since salespeople frequently don't ask for help, many new customers are lost. The problem is usually that simple.

Be frank with your customers. Just explain that you are investing more time into building your business and are looking for new customers. Then, explain that many of your present customers came from the recommendations of other satisfied customers.

3) Ask your customers to help.

You've made the customer aware that you appreciate her business; reminded her of her satisfaction; and planted the fact that you rely on referrals from present customers to produce new business. Now it will be natural for her to respond positively to your request for help. Say, "You wouldn't mind, then, Mrs. Smith, giving me the name of your best friend in the area to call on, would you?

You can get more than one referral. Have your little note pad ready. After you've written down the first referral's name and address, ask, "Who else do you know in this area that I might call on?"

Never ask, "Do you know anyone else..." That leaves an opening for a negative response. You must assume she knows someone else in the area and word your question for a positive response...that is, "Who do you know?"

3) Offer a "thank you" incentive.

After you've taken the three steps listed here, you may offer your customer a "thank you" gift for her help. An inexpensive product or premium from your line is perfect, or a coupon good for a future discount.

Show Appreciation

In this way, you're thanking her, not bribing her. She'll be pleased, won't feel guilty, and will be more willing to help the next time you ask.

The next time you call on that customer you should remember to again thank her for her help. Report to her on the reactions of the prospects she suggested. Let her know that you did call on them, that Mrs. Jones did become a customer and purchased such-and-such, and that Mrs. Walters was interested but wishes to purchase at a later date.

In many cases, after reporting these results, you can again obtain a couple of additional prospects from her.

Prospects are the lifeblood of your business. Your greatest asset in direct sales is your inventory of prospective new customers. And there is no better way to maintain that inventory, converting prospects to customers, than by using the power of word-of-mouth advertising...with recommendations from

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your present, satisfied customers. Put this power to work now and watch your profits and your list of customers multiply.

31 WAYS TO MAKE ADS GENERATE MORE INQUIRIES...compliments of Robert Bly (reprinted from BUSINESS MARKETING MAGAZINE)

1. Ask for action.
2. Offer free information.
3. Describe your (offered) brochure or catalog.
4. Show a picture of your brochure or catalog.
5. Give your literature a title that implies value. "Product Guide" is better than 'catalog.' 'Planning Kit' is better than brochure.
6. Include your address in the last paragraph of copy and beneath your logo, in type that is easy to read.
7. Include a toll-free number.
8. Print the toll-free number in extra large type.
9. Put a small sketch of a telephone next to the phone number.
10. Create a "hot line."
11. For a full-page ad, use a coupon.
12. Make the coupon large enough that readers have plenty of room to write in their name and address.
13. Give the coupon a headline that affirms positive action. Example: "YES, I'd like to cut my energy costs by 50% or more."
14. Give the reader multiple response options.
15. For a fractional ad, put a coupon border around the entire ad.
16. You can then say: for more information, clip this ad and mail it to us with your business card.
17. A bound-in business reply card can increase response by a factor of two or more.
18. Use a direct headline that promises a benefit.
19. Put your offer of a free booklet, report, whatever in the headline.
20. Offer a free gift. (slide rule, pocket ruler)*
21. Offer a product sample.*
22. Offer a free consultation, analysis, recommendation, study, cost estimate, etc.*
23. Stress the offer.*
24. Highlight the free offer in the copy subhead.
25. In a two-page ad, run copy describing your offer in a separate sidebar.
26. Be sure the magazine includes a reader service number in your ad.
27. Use copy/graphics that lead the reader to the reader service number.
28. Consider using more than one reader service number. One for people who want literature, another for immediate response from a sales person.
29. In an ad for multiple products, have a service number for each product.
30. Test different ads.
31. Highlight the theme from the best ads in the current ad.

*These points are 100% compatible with "the widget strategy" I teach in my Magnetic Marketing System. To briefly elaborate, the reason waste exists in advertising is that, when you reach out, regardless of how you reach out, a big percentage of those you reach do not have a (perceived) need and/or desire of your product or service AT THAT MOMENT OF CONTACT. The "trick" to much bigger response is to develop and offer a "widget" that lots of people will want even if they do not (also) immediately want your product or service. This enables you to start and develop relationships, so when they do arrive at the need or desire for your product or service, you're already there. This makes advertising substantially more productive and profitable.

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UPSELLING: THE KEY TO PROFITS.

In many cases these days, the "immediate telephone upsell" is the FIRST profit being made on the new customer acquired through TV, direct-mail, catalog, etc., which requires the use of in-bound telemarketers and/or an automated message. The next profit is often made from outbound telemarketing to the new/recent customer. A couple *examples:*, (1) Country Line Dancing Video buyers, $19.95 from TV spots...are offered an immediate upsell of "More Country Line Dancing" at $9.95 on the inbound....then Info-Cision's* team outbounds, offering a $69.95 video and audio package...with a whopping 17% conversion rate! (2) FitnessQuest uses outbound telemarketing to "flip" its TV buyer of the $59.95 EasyGlider up to the $295.00 FitOne, with a trade-in discount of the $59.95....over 1-1/2 years, InfoCision has completed 223,000 calls, made 19,000 sales (8.5%) and produced 4.8 million in sales. These sort of examples demonstrate several things - one, of course, the efficacy of outbound, used properly and, two, the quality of the work done by Info-Cision; but, three, most important: that we all tend to underestimate the repeat, linked and frequent consumption ability of our customers. InfoCision and I wholeheartedly agree that "planning the back-end comes before the front-end", and I am constantly preaching the vital importance of a comprehensive back-end strategy.

Also, here, quickly: InfoCision's
"10 Golden Rules Of Database Marketing":

1. Learn everything you can about your customer.
2. Make sure your add-ons, cross-sells and up-sells are logical and consistent.

(I might substitute the word "congruent." I learned this lesson some years ago with a company called Winners International, where we sold thousands of brass eagles, mostly to companies and gov't agencies, in bulk, as awards. Our list featured top execs of Fortune 1,000's. We tried going at them with leather briefcases and travel goods, gadgets, day planners, cassette programs, you-name-it, but the only thing they'll buy from us is something with an eagle on it, related to incentive programs. Customers tend to get a 'fix' on you in their minds and then respond well to what is congruent with that.)

3. Explore the opportunities of a continuity program.
4. Before you say "please buy this", say "thanks for buying that."
5. Your lapsed customers are still within reach. Move heaven and earth to bring them back.

(My rule: a customer loses 10% of his value per 30 days of neglect, after his first transaction. 10 months = 0 value. But certainly within that time and, occaisonally, even after that time, the relationship can be jump-started and built properly. One of my clients launched a step-down sale mailing program and successfully went back over 3 years in accumulated, neglected names.)

6. End every phone call, even declines, with a pleasant voice and a polite demeanor.
7. Find new customers who meet the profile of your current customer. The more variables you can match up, the better.
8. Scattershot prospecting is foolhardy.

(Even the smallest of businesses can take #1 + this #7 +8 and use such a smart strategy to precisely target its lead generation advertising and/or its direct-mail.)

9. INTEGRATED marketing makes sense. Stand-alone phone calls do not.

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(As you know, I am NOT an advocate of "cold" tele-prospecting/marketing. In fact, I hate it. I did it once myself, in 1971, for two weeks, and have never done it again. When I see salespeople doing this, I get ill. BUT "relationship telemarketing" can work beautifully; to a qualified lead, after multiple contacts, or to new, past or present customers. There IS a place in each marketing chain for telemarketing.)

10. Be flexible when marketing by phone. Change what doesn't work and fine-tune continuously.

*All of this - Courtesy of Steve Pittendrigh, Alisa Getzinger and Eric Sherman at InfoCision...I believe to be the finest outbound telemarketing company in existence. And if you have lead flow, customer files, etc. in the tens of thousands, you may want to see what these folks can do for you. Send some info to Steve or call and BE CERTAIN to mention that I suggested you contact him. InfoCision; 325 Springside Dr., Akron, Ohio 44333

MAIL VS. PHONE PROSPECTING

The giant financial services company IDS is favoring the mail. Mike Donoghue, who markets the introductory seminars for one of their offices, says his office's prospecting mail has gone from near-zero to 15,000 pieces a week. Donoghue says part of the motivation for the new emphasis on mailings is current and anticipated legislation restricting "cold" telephone prospecting. At our recent $3,495-Per-Person Direct Marketing Conference, the spokesperson from InfoCision, one of the largest outbound telemarketing service bureaus in America, made the point that "cold" telephone prospecting is usually a losing proposition; they deal only with telemarketing to established customers or pre-qualified prospects, i.e. 'relationship telemarketing.' All of this supports my long-standing advice: (1) Put the outbound call late in your prospecting sequence, almost as a last resort; (2) Use outbound calls for customer service, for upsells, for conversion to continuity or subscription programs, or for special event, sale or new offer marketing to established customers.

GETTING CUSTOMERS WITHOUT GOING BROKE
(Reprinted from SPARE TIME MAGAZINE)

Early in my business career, I was wisely advised, "Boy, the first thing you gotta do is avoid going broke while you're getting rich and famous."

Had I paid closer attention, I might very well have saved myself from considerable financial strife.

Observing others, I've noticed how often entrepreneurs bankrupt themselves with expensive advertising and marketing schemes, when their interests would be better served by low-cost methods.

When you stop to think about it, it's easy to "buy customers." Given enough money (or credit), any idiot can build u a business, and many idiots have, using up millions of dollars of stockholders' equity in the process.

Genius, on the other hand, is in getting customers and making sales ***without*** having to use up a huge chunk of capital doing it. The ideas presented here are dedicated to that objective.

It's Opportunity Calling!

The phone rang persistently in the little shoe store where I was buying a pair of shoes. Finally, after six rings, the clerk at the counter said, "Dammit - I'm busy," but grudgingly answered the phone. Guess how he sounded to the caller.

This attitudinal error must occur a million times a day in every type of business, as the incoming call "interrupts" the important work. Fix this, and

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you've taken a giant step forward in attracting new customers as well as retaining the ones you have.

An inbound call can be many things: the tax collector, your mother-in-law announcing a surprise two-week visit, or the merchant across the street reporting that your roof is on fire. These calls have varying degrees of importance. But the call may be from a prospective customer, a present customer, or a former customer.

And that is opportunity calling! These calls must not be thought of as interruptions.

If the all is from a prospective customer, the job of the person handling the call must be clearly defined, understood, and enthusiastically pursued: to get the customer into the store (if you have one), or to get his name, address and phone number, or to set up an appointment. It is *not* just to dispense information.

Let me tell you one of the most instructive true marketing stories I have ever encounterd as a marketing consultant:

> The owner of a large auto-parts store was extraordinarily frustrated with his advertising, complaining about weekly expenditures of tens of thousands of dollars in the newspaper, on radio and on television, all yielding few customers.
> But a conversation with his employees revealed their frustration with the constant ringing of the phone -- calls from people asking questions, constantly interrupting them. A Saturday in his store provided a count of over 200 incoming calls.
> Here's how every one was handled, with varying levels of courtesy and friendliness:
> "XYZ Auto Parts - how can we help you?"
> The caller would then state his business. Most often, his inquiry sounded like this: "I saw (heard) your ad - how much is a flibitty-gibbet for a '78 Ford?"
> The answer then went like this:
> "Lemme look it up - hold on...still there? It's sixty-two-fifty."
> Click.

As you can immediately detect, there was no problem at all with this guy's advertising. And, to be fair, his people really weren't at fault either.

He was the problem. He was the one who had no earthly idea what was going on inside his own business. He was the one who had failed to educate his people about the importance of those calls. He was the one who had failed to train his people in the effective handling of the calls. He as the one who had failed to motivate his people. He was the one who had failed to monitor their performance.

Here's what we did:

1) We devised a new phone script to capture the caller's name, address and phone number.

2) We taught the script to all the employees.

3) We instituted a reward pool of 50 cents per captured name, address and phone number, divided at day's end by everybody working that day.

4) We added a "telephone upsell" to the script.

Immediately, with this strategy, the number of callers converted - the ones who came into the store that same day - increased significantly.

Overall, after followup mailings to all the callers, the store captured over 50% of the callers as customers!

In addition, we added revenue and profit with the telephone upsell.

You're familiar with this if you've ever ordered by phone from a well-run catalog company. After the operator has taken your order, she'll do a "Columbo." "Oh, just one more thing....we have a special offer for today's callers - would you like to hear about it? (I recently ordered from the wonderful Horchow company, and the operator walked me through six different specials.)

This technique works in that application, and there's no reason it can't work in others.

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The auto parts store's upsell script sounded like this:

"Oh, just one more thing - we have an extra special offer just for today's callers. Would you like to hear about it?"

Over 70% said yes.

"Good. Any caller who comes in today or by noon tomorrow will receive a 5% discount coupon good for any purchase in the store and a free copy of our 400-page catalog. Also, there's a sale right now on (insert product). I can set your coupon and catalog aside in your name if you are coming in. Should I do that?"

Over 50% said yes. Over 25% actually showed up. Over 15% came in, bought the item they originally called to ask about, *and* bought the sale item described on the phone.

Reach Out And Grab A Customer

Fact: the telephone lines run in both directions, in and out.

According to Bernie Goldberg, author of the book *How to Manage and Execute Telephone Selling*, someone making out-bound telemarketing calls to homes can average 25 to 35 dialings per hour and 10 to 15 completed calls per hour; someone calling businesses, 20 to 30 dialings and 5 to 10 completed calls per hour.

If a person costs you $5 per hour and completes just 5 calls, that's a cost of $1 per presentation; if the person gets 10 done, the cost is down to .50 each. This is comparable to, or less than, other advertising and marketing methods, and much faster to get done.

Why the telephone? Well, just about everybody's got one. And just about everybody answers it when it rings. They may skip your ad in the newspaper. They may throw out your mail unopened. But when the phone rings, they answer.

My appreciation for the phone goes back to age 15, when I decided to make some money selling Amway products. My parents were distributors, and I have to say, as an aside, that the exposure to selling, to certain attitudes, and to ambitious people that I got, thanks to their involvement, was and is priceless.

Having no money with which to advertise and no car in which to get around and no friends, relatives or neighbors to sell to - those were my parents' customers - I was left with the telephone and the White Pages. With some help, I devised a little telephone survey, beginning with questions about environmental and water-pollution concerns...then switching to a pitch for Amway's biodegradable, ecologically wonderful, etc., laundry compound.

Even the fuzziness of the passing of time has not blurred the memory of how miserable it was to make these calls: hundreds and hundreds of no answers, hundreds of people too old, too young, unable to speak English, or unbelievably nasty, and hours without a positive response.

But I also clearly remember the "thrill of victory." And, more important, I can look back and realize that even with a lousy script, terrible technique, and no selectivity in prospects, I still made money and acquired customers.

I long ago left that business, but I happen to know that some of those customers are still buying Amway products today, month after month after month, each having cumulatively spent tens of thousands of dollars.

There are smarter ways to use telemarketing than that, but there are worse ways to acquire customers, too.

And there is one overwhelmingly superior way most businesses should use telemarketing, if they use it only one way: link it to a direct mail campaign.

WATCH OUT FOR THE 'ANTI-SALES ATTITUDE"

In the office complex where our offices are, the owner has a "No Soliciting" sign posted, and my teeth grate every time I walk past it. It's wrong. Salespeople should be welcomed...each one brings new ideas, new opportunities, new contacts and networking possibiliites. Of course, that must be balanced with control of time. I, for example, won't see a walk-in or take a cold call, but sales folks are always invited to submit material by mail; I do look at all of it; and I do talk with quite a few salespeople. In fact, I

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wish there were more good ones out there. Anyway, our little, local paper had a notice about needing money for kids from low income families to play in Little League, so I decided to call up and give 'em a few hundred bucks - and here's the phone message I heard: "You've reached 997-0247. If you're selling something, we don't want it. If not, leave a message and we'll call you back." Since people who sell things have most of the money in our society, alienating them when begging does not seem to be very smart - what do you think?

How Even Small Business Owners & Salespeople Can (And Should) Make A Bundle With "Joint Venture Marketing"

At our most recent DM Conference, Ted Thomas spoke about his remarkable success with Joint Venture Marketing (the only kind he uses), and it reminded me that even small biz folks and sales pros can use the same tactics...for minimum cost, maximum results promotion...better than anything else!

Method #1: Cross-Endorsed Mailings

Let's assume you own a men's clothing store. And your buddy happens to be an optometrist. You've got a list of loyal, responsive customers who know and respect you; he has a list of loyal, responsive patients who know and respect him. On your letterhead, in your envelopes, from you, to your list, goes a letter singing the praises of your optometrist. On his letterhead, in his envelopes, from him, to his list, goes his letter singing the praises of your store. Discount coupons, optional but suggested. (For sample letter, see the Magnetic Marketing System.)

Because of the endorsement, these letters 'pull' much, much, much better than any other kind of direct-mail or, for that matter, any other advertising.

If you add to this your own followup sequence (ala "the plumber story"), you'll hit a home run.

Now, what if you want to reach someone's list this way but he does not want to reach your list? PAY HIM. Preferably a percentage of the resulting sales.

Or, another scenario (Ted's) is: if you have a "hot" product or offer that will be of great interst to someone's list, you can get that merchant to mail your offer to his list AT HIS EXPENSE, and pay him based on the sales. This is ZERO RISK ADVERTISING for you. So, let's bring this down to a "small business level" with....

Method #2: Package Or Statement Stuffers

Let's say you own a map store. (There happens to be one here in Phoenix; they sell every imaginable map, atlas, some travel books, etc.) You find a travel agency with a good list, that sends out invoices and statements to many customers and delivers tickets to many customers. You say: "Mr. Agent, I have a way you can make some nice extra profits this month for doing nothing - and your customers will thank you for it too." You explain that you will furnish a proven flyer or brochure or letter about your store with a discount coupon, imprinted "Courtesy of XYZ Travel Agency"...all he has to do is put it in the envelope with the tickets he delivers and in with the invoices he mails....and you'll pay him $5 for every coupon that gets redeemed. Because of the close message-to-market match at work here, 10%, 20%, maybe even 30% will be redeemed. He distributes 500, 150 are redeemed, he makes $750. (Do you have any idea how many tickets he has to write to NET $750?)

If you get very, very good at doing this with one merchant after another, you can replace your pre-paid, at-risk advertising entirely.

Method #3: "Bird Dogs"

Or "Finders." Let's say that I sell real estate, and I want to work with "first time home buyers." I think I'll go around and introduce myself to a bunch of apartment complex managers, give them several sealed-enveolope "kits" marked: "For Renters Thinking About Buying A Home," and I'll give the apartment manager $50 or $100 for every referral I sell a home to. If I'm a

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car salesman, auto body shop guys can be my bird dogs. If I'm a dog trainer, pet store owners can be my bird dogs. (No puns intended.)

Method #4: Shared Cost Mailings

Our last Issue had an article about shared-cost TV. Commercial operations like Val-Pak are really shared cost mailings. You can do your own.

12 WAYS TO MAKE YOUR TRADE SHOW PAY BIG
by Mark S.A. Smith

There's no doubt about it, trade shows are hot! More companies than ever are successfully participating in trade shows, and are increasing their budgets for show participation as they see a strong return on their investment. These companies know that you can accomplish more in three days at a trade show than you can do in a month of making sales calls.

What Attracts Visitors To Shows?

People go to trade shows to make buying decisions - either immediately or for the future. In the case of national and international industry trade shows, people are there because they need to be there - they have to solve problems now. In the past, trade show attendance was sometimes offered as a reward. No longer! Management now only sends people to shows who can make an impact on business opportunities, right now.

Visitors want to see, hear, feal, taste, and experience what's new. They're interested in finding what is available that could make their life easier, and let them do things faster, better, and cheaper. People have *wants* they are willing to pay to satisfy, and they go to a show to look for ways to do it.

One Stop Shopping

Companies in the market for major purchases send decision makers to shows to find out who are the players in the industry. Visitors consider companies they see at key trade shows to be credible vendors, with few exceptions.

At a show, a visitor can see all the people they could do business with, talk with key officers of the company, examine and compare competitive products, discuss technical details with designers and engineers, and enter into preliminary negotiations with the sales manager. In short, they can do - in a matter of hours - what may take weeks of work outside of the show.

Visitors have discovered that vendors are more willing to discuss future product plans, since their competition is so close and visible.

Why Should You Go?

There are lots of good reasons for you to attend a trade show as an exhibitor. Here are twelve of the best reasons to go to the show.

Sell what you offer to visitors. Without a doubt, this is the best reason to go to a trade show. Visitors are there to solve problems and make purchase decisions.

Many visitors have the authority to buy on the spot. Don't believe other exhibitors who tell you that people at a show won't buy then and there. There are some shows where show management has declared that selling is forbidden. This doesn't mean you can't take orders, it just means you can't sell products that visitors walk away from the show with.

Consider a trade show as a time machine. You'll make more sales calls in an hour than you can make in a day. Done right, you'll make a month's worth of sales at a three-day show.

Sell what you offer to other exhibitors. A reverse show where you're targeting the other exhibitors, instead of the visitors, works very well if you supply goods and services that the exhibitors use in their daily business. In several days, you can make hundreds of calls, to current customres and new prospects, and all right there ont he trade show floor. You can do a year's

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worth of cold calling, and speak to people that you would never otherwise reach.

Reverse selling means you need to be on the floor before the show opens during setup, out scouting during slow periods - when other exhibitors are dying to talk to someone so they can complain about their aching feet, and network during the parties during the show. Keep your exhibit up for several hours after the show closes, and let other exhibitors know that you'll be there at the end of the show ready to help them.

A moving and storage company decided to do a reverse show at a computer show. About two hours before the show closed, they handed boxes to exhibitors for them to pack up their stuff - in exchange for a business card. Most exhibitors were grateful for the extra boxes - people accumulate stuff at a show, and the moving and storage company got a number of great leads for computer installation and moving.

Get leads for your sales force to follow up. Many companies go to shows to get leads. This is a good secondary reason to be at the show. You can gather more qualified leads at a trade show than from virtually any other marketing activity. If you collect leads at a show, you must have a good followup system ready to take those contacts and turn them into customers. Only 15-20% of trade show leads are followed up effectively in the U.S.! I received a followup letter from a major telecommunications vendor six months after a show I attended.

Establish industry positioning. The easiest way to establish yourself in an industry is to attend the major industry trade show, buy a lot of floor space, and create a "village." You will be the talk of the show, and virtually every visitor will want to know who you are and what you do.

This is effective if you have lots of money and really want to launch yourself into a market quickly.

Meet with existing customers. You can make weeks and months worth of sales calls to your existing customers in a short period of time.

To make this work, you have to actively invite your existing customers and give them a strong reason to attend. We'll talk more about pre-show promotions that bring in the buyers later.

If you have equipment that's hard to transport, you can demonstrate it to lots of customers for a one-time freight bill - the show floor. And if you do it right, one of your customers will pay the equipment's freight bill from the show to their facility!

Visit with people that are hard to otherwise meet. You can get to key buyers who are otherwise unapproachable at trade shows. They are out of their office, on neutral territory, and fair game for you.

Decide who you really would like to see at the show, and develop a campaign to get them to the show and into your exhibit. Create a "hit list" of buyers you want to sell to, and do everything in your power to get them dying to meet with you at the show. We'll explore how in later articles.

Introduce new products to the market. Many companies introduce new product offerings at trade shows. This works great if you can coordinate a product launch with a trade show.

A bit of advice - don't let the trade show schedule drive your product announcements. Companies have been badly burned by pre-announcing products that weren't complete, and killed sales because customers decided to wait for the new product. When sales dropped, so did the money to fund the completion of the product.

And likewise, don't hold off on announcing a product waiting for a trade show. Your sales momentum gets going during the first 90 days of your product announcement. Don't let a competitor scoop you by holding off.

Do market research. At trade shows, visitors will walk by your exhibit once, and only once, unless you've given them a really good reason to come back.

You can capitalize on this fact by using the show for test marketing. Since a visitor only sees you once, you can change your exhibit signs to test

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different headlines, different prices, even different features and benefits. You can in just a few days, try new offers out on thousands of people who buy what you offer, and tune your pricing and product focus very quickly.

Find new dealers, represenstatives, and distributors. If you're looking for help distributing what you sell, put a small sign in your exhibit that says "Dealers Wanted," or "Agents Wanted." Distributors are often scouring trade shows for new and exciting products or services to add to their line card. Make it easy for them to spot your hot opportunities. Have one person in your exhibit be responsible for coordinating activities for prospective distributors and arranging followup interviews and signing contracts.

Find new employees. It's virtually inevitable. When the economy is bad, you'll have job seekers walking the show floor. They're usually easy to spot - they've got the suit and tight shoes on and are carrying a briefcase, something most other visitors aren't doing. You'll probably get a few resumes, so decide who's going to take them and what will happen next.

If you're actively looking for workers, go ahead, put up a small sign that says, "Now accepting selected applications." Assign one person to discuss opportunities with candidates, and keep the meeting short so it doesn't interfere with the rest of your selling.

Conduct business meetings. Conducting business meetings is one of the best reasons to go to a show. You can meet with all of your business partners and prospective partners in just a few days. To do the same thing without the show would cost you thousands and weeks on the road.

If you really need to meet on the show floor, create a separate conference room in your exhibit. Some companies make the conference area the second floor of a two-story exhibit. A good alternative to a conference area on the show floor is a nearby hotel suite.

Get education. The educational sessions are good reason to go to an industry or association conference, but don't mix it with the trade show. I've seen too many people miss their exhibit shift because they were tied up in a heated discussion after an educational session.

If you've been to the sessions, you know that some of them can really stir up your thoughts and get your creativity going. It's virtually impossible to concentrate on solving your visitor's problems when your mind is racing at top speed because of a session you've just attended.

If you schedule an educational session, plan for a period of time after the session before your exhibit shift to cool down. If you don't need it - some of the sessions are boring - then you can do something else productive, like show up to the exhibit early. But save the report on the session until that evening's show review meeting.

Get media exposure. The trade press are at industry and association shows national media are at large consumer shows.

The danger is that a competitor may scoop you at the show killing carefully-laid media plans. Sometimes front page products get pushed to the back page because of a competitor's campaign that reduces the new product introduction's impact.

More and more companies are discovering that trade shows, done right, can create a substantial part of their business.

MURRAY RAPHAEL - ONE OF MY FAVORITE DOWN-TO-EARTH MARKETING SUPERSTARS

....Murray's a retailer and restaurant owner who uses direct marketing - and he writes a column for 'Direct Marketing Magazine.' I recommend his book: "But Would Saks Do It?" to every shop owner. Well, here's one of his latest success stories, from the Deli in Gordon's Alley, Atlantic City: the Casino Reinvestment Development Corp., a government agency, was moving into one of

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the buildings in Gordon's Alley. Few, if any of the 26 new employees knew about the Deli. How to get them to come eat, enjoy, AND RETURN? The deli's owner got the Corp.'s permission to invite all the employees to a 'Welcome To The Alley' Breakfast. They mailed each employee an invitation, with two gift certificates; the first for their new lunch, FREE if used the first week their office opened; the second a 2-for-1 lunch deal good the FOLLOWING week. Purpose: to get this new customer in three times in a row, breakfast, lunch, lunch, to set up a habit pattern. How'd they do? 21 of 26 to breakfast. 25 of 26 redeemed the first lunch coupon. 23 of the 26 redeemed the 2nd coupon. 15 came back the 3rd week and paid full boat, and they've averaged 15 a day ever since. (Approx. $22,500 a year of new biz.)

If you can't apply that to any restaurant, massage therapist, hair salon, car wash, etc., etc., you're asleep at the switch. And if you run a restaurant or retail store, get Murray's book. 609/348-6646.

THE OWNER OF AN INDEPENDENT BOOKSTORE USES CREATIVE MARKETING STRATEGIES

You may recall my recent article about the independent bookstore that died in the face of chain store competition. Had Roger Williams from The Wit & Wisdom Bookstore in New Jersey been there, things might have been different. Here are a few of Roger's marketing tactics:

He puts a little catalog of current business books in the back seats of cars of a limousine service. The customers take the catalogs, call and come in. At a pizza joint down the street from the bookstore, copies of the store's newsletter 'The Reader" are racked - a lot of business comes from this. When there are books to match a movie playing at the theatre down the street, Williams builds a window display at his store AND a book display in the theater lobby. How does he get all this cooperation? He asks for it! For the theater, they use theater tickets in promotions a couple times a year...the pizza shop owner uses Roger's copy machine.

These 'strategic alliances' that work so well are there for the asking, and mostly the exclusive province of the small, local merchant - the giant retail chains are too regimented, management too distant.

Feature: DIRECT MARKETING STRATEGIES: 10 BEST WAYS TO FOLLOW-UP ON A SUCCESSFUL OFFER

1. Mail it again. Try putting just a simple 'lift note' with it..."You must have missed this the first time, when we sent it three weeks ago..." If a piece really pulls from a list, it will often pull almost as well from that same list a second time.

2. Hide it or expose it. If you did "A-Pile Mail' the first time, send it again in a bright colored, junked up, teaser copy laden envelope...if it went in the colored envelope full of teaser copy the first time, send it back out with the A-Pile look.

3. Color it up. Change the colors of the envelope, paper and ink.

4. Add a testimonials page. Take the same stuff and front it with a new sheet that says: "Here's what 15 new customers say about this offer we mailed you three weeks ago..."

5. Up the ante. Add an enclosure that gives an added discount or a new, additional premium. "Since we sent you this offer a month ago, over 3,000

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people have said 'yes.' You have NOT. But I'm as stubborn as you are. So stubborn, I'll knock another $50 off the price AND throw in a FREE xxxxxxucxxx just to get you to try our vhvnbvvnvnn. Now, can you resist THAT?" By the way, never forget the two greatest direct selling/direct marketing models of all time; (1) the Charles Atlas Method, and (2) The Ginzu Knife Method. (If you can't describe these methods, let me know and we'll cover 'em in the next Issue.)

6. Try outbound telemarketing follow-up. At our last DM Conference, a top pro said "We can at least 4x your response by phone." So, get 2% by mail, they'll get another 8% with phone follow-up. In Rory's case (above) 6% goes to 3.3X, to 20%.

7. Go back with same offer, NEW reason for urgency, for immediate reply. Egs: response has been so great we only have a few left.

8. Go back out as an Endorsed Mailing.

9. Go back out as a Tear-Sheet Mailing.

10. Wait 30 days and re-mail the exact same offer a 3RD time. Remember that within every list lies David Ogilvy's "Moving Parade." People's needs and interests change DAILY. Guy gets a mailing from a furniture store; not interested; chucks it. THE NEXT DAY his wife leaves him and takes all the furniture with her. NOW he needs furniture! Since we can't control timing, we must use repetition.

AD WHIZ TO RETAILERS WORLDWIDE, MURRAY RAPHEL

...you'll recall my urging you to get his "Would Saks Fifth Ave." book, and many did. Well, unbeknownst to me, Murray's put together a whole bunch of really good, newer stuff - and now will give my Subscribers a $5.00 discount on any item on the list. Here it is. And if I were you, I'd buy it all:

1) Book: CUSTOMERIZATION. 180 Rules. $19.95
2) Book: TOUGH SELLING FOR TOUGH TIMES. $19.95
3) Cassette: TOUGH SELLING, TOUGH TIMES. $9.95
4) Book: MIND YOUR OWN BUSINESS - full of proven, innovative promotions for various businesses. $19.95
5) 4-Cassettes: MIND YOUR OWN BIZ. $39.95
6) Book: THE GREAT BRAIN ROBBERY. A classic! $19.95
7) Video: STEALING THE COMPETITION. $39.95

S/H $3.50 first item, $1.00 each additonal item. Call 609/348-6646 or FAX 609/347-2455. Raphael Publishing, 12 S. Virginia Ave., Atlantic City, NJ 08401.

By the way, I'm not making a nickel recommending this stuff. I'm delighted to have gotten you the $5-per-item discount....on the above, whole package, that's $35 off!....and to turn you on to some really valuable materials. This is going to sound darned arrogant but; there really are very few, maybe a handful-and-a-half people I know worth very carefully studying, to master direct marketing. I'm #1 on the list, of course. Murray's certainly in my Top Ten.